

Project Primer

Source S-00

Hawthorne Commons Café • Project HC-17 • 14 September 2026

Project and current phase

Hawthorne Commons Café is a 3,200-square-foot ground-floor café and community room being fitted out in an occupied mixed-use building in Portland, Oregon. Buildout started 3 August 2026. The owner targets staff training on 5 October and public opening on 12 October.

Interior framing and major overhead rough-in are substantially complete. The team is coordinating inspections, closing ceilings and soffits, installing custom millwork and preparing for finishes. The north service-counter soffit contains HVAC branches, sprinkler piping, lighting and access panels in a congested zone.

People

Maya Chen	Project manager	Northline Builders • contracts, cost and formal subcontract direction
Luis Ortega	Superintendent	Northline Builders • daily field coordination and sequencing
Priya Shah	Project architect	Atelier North • design interpretation and architect review
Tasha Reed	Owner representative	Hawthorne Commons • owner priorities and user decisions
Ben Walker	HVAC foreman	Cascade Air • field installation and HVAC pricing
Omar Ellis	Fire-protection foreman	Sentinel Fire • sprinkler installation and clearance confirmation
Nina Alvarez	Millwork PM	Timberline Fixtures • custom casework and delivery coordination

Working rules supplied to the project team

- Luis coordinates field sequence but does not approve added subcontract cost.
- Maya issues contractual direction to subcontractors. Added cost above \$2,000 requires Maya’s written authorisation before Northline treats it as approved.
- Tasha can confirm owner preferences, but she does not directly authorise subcontractor changes.
- Priya can confirm design acceptability; she does not approve contractor pricing.
- Verbal direction may be used to protect safety or prevent immediate damage. Otherwise, cost and scope changes should be documented before proceeding.

Reference vocabulary

Rough-in	Mechanical, electrical, plumbing or fire-protection work installed before walls and ceilings are closed
Soffit	A lowered boxed ceiling area used to conceal services or create an architectural feature
Diffuser	A ceiling or wall outlet that distributes conditioned air
Close-in	Covering concealed work after coordination and required inspection
RFI	A formal request for clarification
Change authorisation	Documented agreement changing contract scope, cost or time